

The Ashen Crown

Synthetic Series Manuscript — Continuity Test Document

This fictional manuscript is intentionally seeded with continuity contradictions for testing a Series Bible / RAG / continuity-checking application. Do not treat the contradictions as accidental errors in the test design.

Chapter 1 — The Blue-Eyed Heir

Elena Vey stood beneath the eastern tower as rain swept across the courtyard. Her eyes were unmistakably blue, a trait inherited from her mother. She was twenty-four years old and had served as Captain of the Royal Guard for three years.

Her younger brother Marcus lived in the northern wing of the palace. Elena trusted him more than anyone else in the kingdom.

Chapter 2 — The Northern Road

Marcus left the capital at dawn and rode north toward Castle Raven. Castle Raven stood two days north of the capital, beyond the Silver Forest. Elena remained in the capital to prepare for the Moon Festival.

Chapter 3 — The Moon Festival

The Moon Festival began on the first night of winter. According to the royal calendar, winter always began on the first day of Frostwane. Elena attended the festival in the capital while Marcus was still traveling toward Castle Raven.

Chapter 4 — The Iron Rule

The court mage explained the oldest rule of the kingdom: magic could not pass through solid iron. Iron walls, iron doors, and iron barriers all blocked magical energy.

Chapter 5 — The Raven

Marcus reached Castle Raven and met Elena in the great hall. They discussed the Moon Festival together before Elena returned to the capital that evening.

Chapter 6 — The Green-Eyed Captain

Elena entered the throne room. Her green eyes caught the torchlight as she spoke to the king. She was twenty-six years old and had been Captain of the Royal Guard for five years.

Chapter 7 — The Southern Gate

Marcus was Elena's cousin, not her brother. Their families had never been closely related, though they had grown up together in the palace.

Chapter 8 — The Festival Before Winter

The royal historian recorded that the Moon Festival occurred three weeks before winter began. The festival was therefore held near the end of Autumnfall, not during winter.

Chapter 9 — Through Iron

During the siege, Elena cast a spell through the solid iron gate of Castle Raven. The magic crossed the iron without difficulty and struck the enemy soldiers outside.

Chapter 10 — The Broken Timeline

Elena arrived at Castle Raven before Marcus had ever left the capital. She waited there for him for two days, although earlier accounts placed her in the capital during the same period.

Testing Notes

Expected continuity findings include: Elena's eye color (blue/green), Elena's age and years of service, Marcus's relationship to Elena (brother/cousin), Moon Festival timing (first night of winter/three weeks before winter), the iron magic rule, and contradictory travel/timeline statements.